Another benefit is that a script or blueprint is the most detailed documentation you can imagine (even a computer understands it). If you want to reproduce on Monday what you did last Friday, a script is worth its weight in gold. If you're sick and a coworker needs to take care of your tasks, they will appreciate your blueprints.

You're now going to install and configure the CLI. After that, you can get your hands dirty and start scripting. The AWS CLI is one tool for automating AWS. Read on to learn how it works.

4.2 Using the command-line interface

The AWS CLI is a convenient way to interact with AWS from your terminal. It runs on Linux, macOS, and Windows and provides a unified interface for all AWS services. Unless otherwise specified, the output is by default in JSON format.

4.2.1 Installing the CLI

How you proceed depends on your OS. If you're having difficulty installing the CLI, consult http://mng.bz/AVng for a detailed description of many installation options.

Linux x86 (64-bit)

In your terminal, execute the following commands:

```
$ curl "https:/ /awscli.amazonaws.com/awscli-exe-linux-x86_64.zip" \
➥ -o "awscliv2.zip"
$ unzip awscliv2.zip
$ sudo ./aws/install
```